SahiKarigar: Validation Survey for Workers and Hirers

Version 1 · 4 October 2026 · Interviewer-administered in Hindi or the local language · 15–20 minutes per interview

1. Before you start

What this survey tests

- Workers: Do they have gaps in work and unreliable ways of finding it? Can they use a link-based web app in Hindi? Will they pay ₹50–100 a month?
- Hirers: Is finding a trustworthy worker painful enough that they would switch to a platform, and will they pay for it?

Rules that keep the answers honest

1. Ask about the past before the future. “Last time you hired…” tells you more than “Would you hire…”.
2. Do not mention SahiKarigar until the concept section. Problem questions come first so you don't prime people.
3. Rotate the order of options between interviews. Always allow “Other” and “Don't know”.
4. Read the concept card word for word, in the same neutral tone, to everyone. Never add words like “great”, “easy” or “safe”.
5. Interview workers away from their thekedar or employer. Answers about payment and trust change when the boss is listening.
6. A polite yes is not demand. Every interview ends with a commitment ask (pilot sign-up). Count commitments, not compliments.
7. For rating questions use a 5-point face scale (😟 to 😀) so people who read little can answer by pointing.
8. Take oral consent, keep answers anonymous, and collect a phone number only if the person opts in to the pilot.
9. Suggested sample: about 50 workers (at least 8 per trade, mix of independent and thekedar-attached) and about 50 hirers (roughly 20 homeowners or tenants, 15 shopkeepers, 15 small contractors) across at least 2 towns. Include people who rarely use a smartphone. They are your hardest case and the most important one.

2. Part A: Worker survey

A0. Screener

- **W1.** What work do you mainly do? Plumber / Electrician / Carpenter / Painter / Mistri (mason) / Tile or POP fitter / AC or appliance repair / Helper / Other. (Set quotas by trade.)
- **W2.** Have you done this work for pay in the last 6 months? Yes / No. (If No, end the interview.)
- **W3.** Do you work mostly on your own, mostly under a thekedar or contractor, or both?
- **W4.** Years in this trade: under 2 / 2–5 / 6–10 / over 10.
- **W5.** Age band: under 25 / 25–35 / 36–45 / over 45. (Note gender by observation.)
- **W6.** Reading ability: cannot read / simple Hindi or local language / comfortable in Hindi or local language / also reads English.

A1. How they find work today

- **W7.** How many days did you have paid work in the last 30 days? 0–10 / 11–15 / 16–20 / 21–25 / 26–30.
- **W8.** In those 30 days, how many days did you want work but had none? 0–2 / 3–5 / 6–10 / more than 10.
- **W9.** Think of your last five jobs. How did you get each one? (Multiple answers) Thekedar or contractor / Labour chowk (naka) / Past customer calling again / Referral from a customer / Friend or fellow worker / Hardware, paint or electrical shop / WhatsApp group / Facebook or Instagram / App or website (Justdial, Urban Company etc.) / Knocking on doors or shop to shop / Number on a wall, card or vehicle / Other.
- **W10.** Which one source gave you the most work? Which gave the best-paying work?
- **W11.** Do you pay anyone to get work (thekedar's cut, shop, middleman)? How much, in ₹ or %?
- **W12.** In the last year, how many customers called you back for more work? None / 1–5 / 6–15 / more than 15.
- **W13.** When work is slow, what do you usually do? (Multiple answers) Wait at the naka / Accept lower rates / Travel to another area / Take other kinds of work / Borrow money / Go back to the village / Other.
- **W14.** Have you ever used an app or website to find work? Using now / Used and stopped / Never / Didn't know there were any. If used: which one, what worked, what didn't, why did you stop (if you did)?

A2. Money, fears and trust

- **W15.** Out of your last five jobs, how many paid in full on the same day? Within a week? Later than a week? Part payment or nothing?
- **W16.** In the last 12 months, did any customer or contractor not pay, or pay less than agreed? Roughly how much was it?
- **W17.** Which of these worries you most? Pick your top 3 and put them in order. Not getting enough work / Payment delayed or not paid / Customers bargaining too low / Injury or safety on the job / Being blamed for theft or damage / Disrespectful customers / No savings or insurance in slow months / Cost of tools and materials / Competition from other workers / Other.
- **W18.** How do customers decide whether to trust you today? (Open. Probe: referral, ID, tools, appearance, shop reference.)
- **W19.** Has anyone ever blamed you for theft, damage or bad work? What happened? (Optional. Skip if the person is uncomfortable.)
- **W20.** Which of these do you have? Aadhaar / Voter ID / PAN / Bank account / UPI / e-Shram card / Skill certificate / Photos of past work on your phone.
- **W21.** If a service wanted to check your ID before showing you to customers, how would you feel? Comfortable / Comfortable only if… (ask what) / Not comfortable (ask why).

A3. Phone and digital comfort

- **W22.** Which phone do you use? Own smartphone / Shared smartphone / Keypad phone / None.
- **W23.** How do you get internet? Monthly pack / Short packs when needed / Often no data / Wi-Fi only.
- **W24.** Which do you use at least once a week? WhatsApp / YouTube / Facebook / Instagram / PhonePe, GPay or Paytm / Google Maps / Camera / Voice messages / Other.
- **W25.** Is your phone storage often full? Never / Sometimes / Often. Did you delete an app to make space in the last month?
- **W26.** How do you prefer to use messages? Read and type / Read only / Voice messages only / Ask family or a friend for help.
- **W27.** In the last month, did you receive money from a customer by UPI? Yes / No / Don't use UPI.
- **W28. Observed task (interviewer records, do not ask).** Send a test link on WhatsApp that opens a simple Hindi page with trade icons. Ask the person to open it and pick their trade. Record: completed alone / completed after one hint / needed help / could not complete, and the time taken. Also record whether the Hindi text was understood without help. Use the same page for everyone. This is your best evidence on "no download" comfort because it measures what people do, not what they say.

A4. Concept test

Read aloud: “Imagine a service you open from a link on your phone. Nothing to download. You make a profile with your name, trade, area and photos of your work. Your ID can be checked. People near you who need your kind of work can find you and contact you. After a job, customers can leave a rating.”

- **W29.** How clear was that? (Face scale)
- **W30.** How likely are you to try it? (Face scale) Why?
- **W31.** What would be most useful to you? Pick two. Customers finding you / A verified badge / Ratings / Photos of your work / Job alerts in Hindi / Getting paid through the service / None of these.
- **W32.** How do you feel about customers rating you after a job? Good / Don’t mind / Worried. Why?
- **W33.** What would stop you from using it? (Open first. Then prompt: no time, don’t trust it, data cost, ID privacy, don’t believe leads will come, not sure how to use it.)
- **W34.** How would you know that a customer enquiry is genuine? (Open. Probe: verified phone, address, job details, budget.)
- **W35.** How many genuine customer contacts a month would make it worth your while? _____

A5. Willingness to pay

- **W36.** Have you paid for anything to help you get work or run your work (commission, tool loan, shop credit, visiting cards, ads)? What, and how much in a month?
- **W37. Price test (randomised).** Give each respondent only one price card, rotating across interviews: ₹30 / ₹50 / ₹100 / ₹150 per month. Ask: “Suppose this service gave you contacts of real customers near you for ₹[price] a month. Would you pay?” Yes / No / Not sure. If yes: “And at double that?” If no: “And at half?” Record the highest price accepted and the lowest price refused.
- **W38.** At that price, how many jobs from the service in the first month would make you pay again for the second month?
- **W39.** Which way of paying suits you best? Fixed monthly amount / Pay only when you get a customer contact / Small cut only after a job is done / Free to join, pay later / Yearly at a discount. Why?
- **W40.** How would you pay? UPI / Cash to a local agent / Deducted from mobile recharge / Not sure.
- **W41.** If the first month were free, would you try it? Yes / No.
- **W42.** How many other workers in your trade do you know in your town? Would you tell them about it? Yes / No.

- **W43. Commitment ask.** “We are starting a small trial in your area soon. May I note your number to send you the link?” Yes / No. Record the answer.
- **W44.** Anything else you would like to tell us? (Open)

3. Part B: Hirer survey

B0. Screener

- **H1.** Which describes you best? Homeowner / Tenant / Shopkeeper or business owner / Small contractor or builder / Landlord or property manager / Other.
- **H2.** In the last 12 months, did you hire a plumber, electrician, carpenter, painter or mistri? Yes / No. (If No, end the interview.)
- **H3.** Who usually decides on hiring at home or in the business? Me / Spouse or family / Landlord / Shared.
- **H4.** Age band, own or rent, and city and locality (for quotas).

B1. How they hire today

- **H5.** Think of the last time you hired. Which trade and what job? Approximate cost: under ₹500 / ₹500–2,000 / ₹2,000–10,000 / ₹10,000–50,000 / more. Was it urgent or planned?
- **H6.** How did you find that worker? (Multiple answers) Neighbour, friend or family / Thekedar or contractor / Hardware, electrical or plumbing shop / Labour chowk / Same worker as before / WhatsApp or community group / Google, Justdial or an app / Society or RWA staff / Social media / Other.
- **H7.** From deciding to hire to the worker starting: same day / 1–2 days / 3–7 days / more than a week.
- **H8.** How many people did you call or ask before you found one? 1 / 2–3 / 4–5 / more than 5.
- **H9.** How easy or hard was it to find someone? (Face scale) What was the hardest part? (Open)
- **H10.** How do you usually settle the price? Ask 2–3 quotes / Fixed daily rate / Fixed price per job / Accept what the worker says / Through a contractor.
- **H11.** Looking back, was the price fair? Paid more than fair / Fair / Paid less than usual / Can't judge.
- **H12.** Do you have a regular person for each trade? Always the same / Sometimes / Usually someone new.

- **H13.** Have you used an app or website to hire tradespeople? Using now / Used and stopped / Never. If used: which one, what you liked, what annoyed you, why you stopped or continued.

B2. Problems and fears

- **H14.** Out of the last 5 times you hired, how many times did the worker: not show up / come more than an hour late / do work you had to get redone / charge more than agreed / leave work unfinished / damage something / something go missing? (Number from 0 to 5 for each)
- **H15.** Which concerns you most when someone you don't know comes into your home or shop? Pick your top 3 and put them in order. Not showing up / Poor quality work / Overcharging / Theft / Safety of family members at home / Damage to property / Mess left behind / Inflated material costs / No help if something goes wrong later / Dishonesty about what is wrong / Other.
- **H16.** Have you or someone you know had a bad experience with a hired worker? What happened? (Optional)
- **H17.** What do you do today to feel safe? (Multiple answers) Hire only on referral / Stay present during the work / Keep valuables away / Take a copy of ID / Note phone number and address / Tell family or neighbours / Nothing special / Other.
- **H18.** Do you check any ID of workers? Always / Sometimes / Never. If never, why not?
- **H19.** Whose recommendation do you trust most? Rank: Neighbour / Family / Hardware shop / A worker you used before / Contractor / Online reviews / Society or RWA.
- **H20.** When something goes wrong after a job, what do you usually do? Call the same worker back / Find someone else / Pay to fix it / Argue or complain / Let it go.

B3. Concept test

Read aloud: "Imagine a service you open from a link on your phone. Nothing to download. Workers on it have had their ID checked. Each has a profile with trade, experience, photos of past work and ratings from earlier customers. You say what work you need, see workers near you with their ratings and usual rates, and contact one. After the job you can rate them."

- **H21.** How clear was that? (Face scale)
- **H22.** How likely would you be to use it the next time you need a worker? (Face scale) Why?
- **H23.** For each of these, how much more would you trust a worker you have never met? No difference / A little / A lot. (Rotate the order.) ID checked by the service / Ratings from earlier customers / Photos of past work / Police verification / Worker's photo and

local address / Service guarantee for damage or no-show / A neighbour's recommendation.

- **H24.** How much would you trust ratings from strangers? (Face scale) Would you leave a rating after a job? Yes / No / Maybe.
- **H25. Choice test.** "For a one-day job, which would you hire?" A: ID-verified, 4.5 stars from 30 customers, ₹800 / B: not verified, recommended by your neighbour, ₹650 / C: not verified, no ratings, ₹500. Ask why. Then repeat with A at ₹700 and ask whether the answer changes.
- **H26.** What would have to be true before you trusted a service like this? (Open)
- **H27.** How would you prefer to use it? Call the worker directly / Chat / Book a time slot / The service sends someone / Through WhatsApp / Through a phone helpline.
- **H28.** How comfortable are you with: opening a link, entering an OTP, paying through UPI inside the service? (Face scale for each)

B4. Willingness to pay

- **H29.** Which way of paying for a service like this feels most acceptable? Free for you (the worker pays) / A small fixed fee per booking / A percentage added to the job cost / A monthly subscription / Pay only for a guarantee. Why?
- **H30. Price test (randomised).** Each respondent sees one card: ₹0 (control) / ₹30 / ₹50 / ₹99 per booking. "If the worker is ID-verified and rated, would you pay ₹[price] on top of the worker's charge?" Yes / No / Depends. If it depends, on what?
- **H31.** Would you pay more than the normal rate to a verified and rated worker? No / Up to 10% / 10–20% / More than 20%.
- **H32.** (For shops, landlords, contractors and anyone who hires every month) Would you pay a monthly subscription of ₹[randomise: 99 / 199 / 299 / 499] for reliable access to verified workers? Yes / No / Depends.
- **H33.** Which one would make you most willing to pay? A replacement if the worker doesn't show up / Free redo within 7 days / Damage cover / Same-day arrival / Fixed, published rates / None of these.
- **H34. Contractors only.** How many workers do you hire in a month? How do you find them? What does one no-show cost you (days of delay or ₹)? Would you source regular or bulk needs through a service like this?
- **H35. Commitment ask.** "We are starting a small trial in your area. May I note your number to send you the link when you next need a worker?" Yes / No. Would you recommend it to a neighbour or colleague? Yes / No.
- **H36.** Monthly household or business income band (optional).
- **H37.** Anything else you would like to tell us? (Open)

4. Reading the results

These thresholds are rules of thumb, not industry standards. Decide your own cut-offs before fieldwork so the results can't bend your judgement.

Signal	Encouraging	Warning
Workers: days wanted work but had none (W8)	6 or more days for 40%+ of workers	Under 25%
Workers: link task (W28)	60%+ finish with at most one hint	Under 40%
Workers: likely to try (W30)	50%+ pick the top two faces	Under 30%
Workers: accept ₹50 a month (W37)	40%+	Under 20%
Workers: pilot sign-up (W43)	40%+	Under 20%
Hirers: at least one no-show or quality issue in last 5 hires (H14)	40%+	Under 20%
Hirers: pick verified worker at higher price (H25)	50%+	Under 25%
Hirers: accept ₹30–50 fee (H30)	30%+	Under 15%
Hirers: pilot sign-up (H35)	30%+	Under 15%

Stated willingness to pay usually overstates real behaviour, so expect actual conversion to be roughly half of what people say.

Cut the results by trade, thekedar-attached versus independent, town, smartphone user versus not, and hirer segment (home, shop, contractor).

Three things to look for beyond the averages

1. **Who pays.** If workers refuse ₹50 but hirers accept a ₹30–50 fee, consider charging hirers, or a small commission after the job, instead of a worker subscription.
2. **The supply and demand loop.** Workers will pay only if leads actually arrive. Compare the contacts workers need (W35) with how often hirers hire (H5, H7). Plan to build hirer demand in a few neighbourhoods first.
3. **The say-do gap.** Pilot sign-ups and the observed link task (W28) matter more than stated likelihood or stated prices.

5. Appendix: Hindi wording for key questions

Have a native speaker adjust these for local dialect and for other regional languages.

- **Worker concept card:** “सोचिए, आपके फ़ोन पर एक लिंक खुलता है। कुछ डाउनलोड नहीं करना। उसमें आपका नाम, काम, इलाका और पुराने काम की फ़ोटो होती है। आपकी पहचान की जाँच हो सकती है। आपके आस-पास जिन्हें आपके जैसे कारीगर की ज़रूरत है, वे आपको ढूँढकर संपर्क कर सकते हैं। काम के बाद ग्राहक रेटिंग दे सकते हैं।”
- **W15 (payment):** “पिछले पाँच कामों में से कितनों में पूरा पैसा उसी दिन मिला?”
- **W21 (ID check):** “अगर ग्राहकों को दिखाने से पहले आपकी पहचान (जैसे आधार) जाँची जाए, तो आपको कैसा लगेगा?”
- **W32 (rating):** “काम के बाद ग्राहक आपको रेटिंग दें, इस बारे में आप क्या सोचते हैं?”
- **W37 (price):** “मान लीजिए यह सेवा हर महीने ₹[कीमत] में आपके इलाके के असली ग्राहकों के नंबर दिलाती है। क्या आप यह लेंगे?”
- **H15 (fear):** “किसी अनजान कारीगर को घर या दुकान में बुलाते समय आपको सबसे ज़्यादा किस बात की फ़िक्र रहती है?”
- **H30 (price):** “अगर कारीगर की पहचान जाँची हुई हो और पुराने ग्राहकों की रेटिंग हो, तो क्या आप उसके मेहनताने के ऊपर ₹[कीमत] देंगे?”